

2-Hour Media Intake Sprint

WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 26, 2026

Desk Intake Goal: give DBF enough real Delaware media to replace illustrations, deepen stories, and make the 2026 mobile product feel unmistakably human.

SUCCESS IF YOU STOP AFTER 2 HOURS WITH:

- ☐ 12-25 strong, original/full-resolution Delaware photos in one upload folder or ZIP
- ☐ 3-5 short original DBF video clips if available
- ☐ Each selected file tied to a place/subject with no guessing
- ☐ A Top 12 list for immediate homepage/article deployment
- ☐ One ZIP ready to upload to ChatGPT / hand to Claude Code

Do not turn this into a photo-organization project. Curate the best assets, preserve originals, stop at two hours.

Why This Block Matters

The code is no longer the binding constraint. DBF now has a live Weekend franchise, working live-camera surfaces, a much shorter swipe-based homepage, article sharing, and stable technical QA. The visible gap is real photography and short-form visual media. Claude reported that 10 of 34 homepage images remain illustrations. Before shooting anything new, we need to reconcile what Michael already owns and has already supplied.

The Two-Hour Plan

TIME	JOB	WHAT “DONE” MEANS
0:00-0:10	Set up one clean intake folder	Create the folder and sources. No editing, renaming marathon, or Lightroom session.
0:10-0:35	Harvest the obvious winners	Pull the strongest real Delaware photos from the places you already know. Copy, do not move originals.
0:35-1:05	Fill the visual gaps	Target the specific places and content types that would immediately replace illustrations and upgrade articles.
1:05-1:15	Walk away for 10 minutes	Actual break. When you return, choose with fresh eyes.
1:15-1:40	Minimal labeling + rights sanity check	Give each selected file enough context that no AI has to guess where or what it is.
1:40-1:55	Pick the Top 12 + best clips	Select the first assets Claude should deploy, not merely archive.
1:55-2:00	ZIP + save + stop	Create one upload-ready package. End the block even if the library is not perfect.

0:00-0:10 — Setup

- ☐ Create: DBF_MEDIA_TO_UPLOAD_2026-08-26
- ☐ Inside it create: TOP_12, PHOTOS, VIDEO, and NOTES
- ☐ Open the likely sources: Photos app/iCloud, Desktop/Downloads, ~/Media/DBF/, phone, external drive if relevant
- ☐ Copy files only. Do not reorganize or rename the master library.

0:10-0:35 — Harvest the Obvious Winners

Use the “would I stop scrolling for this?” test. Pull only strong candidates. Prioritize:

- Lewes waterfront / canal / working harbor / streetscape
- Rehoboth Boardwalk, beach, downtown, Grove Park, recognizable local context
- Cape Henlopen: towers, dunes, trails, beach, Gordons Pond, wildlife
- Dewey / Indian River Inlet / Towers Beach / Delaware Seashore
- Bethany / Fenwick / recognizable south-coast imagery
- People-scale moments: walkers, bikes, dogs, boats, markets, beach setups - when privacy/rights are appropriate
- One or two Homes & Design frames: real Delaware coastal exterior/interior if you have them
- Atmospheric detail: signs, dune grass, boardwalk texture, boats, weather, surf, marsh, sunrise/sunset

0:35-1:05 — Fill the Gaps That Move the Site Immediately

Do not hunt randomly. The highest-value assets are the ones that can replace a visible illustration or add breathing room to a strong story this week.

PRIORITY	PLACE/TYPE	GET THIS	WHY IT MATTERS
Tier 1	Lewes	Landscape hero + waterfront/canal + one detail shot	Town rail, stories, homepage, pilots/tide/osprey context
Tier 1	Cape Henlopen	Tower + landscape/dunes/trail + wildlife if owned	High-value evergreen stories, commerce context, town/park discovery
Tier 1	Rehoboth	Boardwalk/beach/ downtown/Grove Park	Highest-recognition acquisition surface
Tier 2	Delaware Seashore / Inlet / Dewey	Bridge, inlet, beach, road/coast context	Town rail, guides, live/traffic context
Tier 2	Bethany / Fenwick	Real landscape and recognizable local context	Replace illustration-heavy town surfaces
Tier 2	Homes & Design	1-3 genuinely good property/design frames	Allows the department to stop feeling like a placeholder
Bonus	Short video	5-20 second clean vertical or landscape clips	Watch/visual module, article motion, Reel-to-web bridge

Photo Selection Rule

KEEP a photo if it is technically usable and tells a human where they are or what it feels like to be there. **SKIP** near-duplicates, screenshots, tiny downloads, obvious filters, blurry frames, and anything whose location you cannot identify confidently.

1:05-1:15 — Break

Get up. Ten minutes. Do not spend the break sorting photos.

1:15-1:40 — Minimal Labeling

You do not need museum-grade metadata. For each selected file, enough information to avoid guessing is the goal.

- ☐ Put a COPY of each selected photo in PHOTOS or TOP_12
- ☐ If the filename is meaningless, rename the copy using: town_subject_optional-date_original#
- ☐ Examples: lewes_canal_waterfront_01.jpg; cape-henlopen_tower_01.heic; rehoboth_boardwalk_evening_02.jpg
- ☐ If you know when it was taken and the date matters, add YYYY-MM or YYYY-MM-DD
- ☐ If you did NOT take the media yourself, make a note of the source/permission instead of assuming rights
- ☐ Do not resize, compress, crop, watermark, or overwrite originals for this intake

What Would Take DBF to the Next Level If You Can Get It to Me

- 1. Original-resolution photography** — The biggest unlock. JPG/HEIC/PNG originals or high-quality exports, not screenshots. 20 great photos beat 200 mediocre ones.
- 2. Five true “hero” images** — Wide, sharp, visually unmistakable Delaware frames suitable for homepage/town/story leads. Lewes, Rehoboth, Cape Henlopen, south coast, and one wildcard.
- 3. Three to five clean short video clips** — 5-20 seconds, no text overlays if possible. Water, wildlife, boardwalk, traffic/coast approach, markets, boats, dunes, weather. These can make the site move without social embeds.
- 4. Human-scale local moments** — Not influencer posing. Real life: people walking, bikes, dogs, boats, beach setups, market scenes, trail activity - only where privacy/usage is appropriate.
- 5. One Homes & Design mini-set** — Even 3-6 strong images from one real coastal exterior/interior can turn an “in progress” department into something visually credible.
- 6. Location certainty** — A simple note saying exactly where each photo was taken is often more valuable than elaborate editing. It lets the site use the image intelligently and truthfully.
- 7. Rights certainty** — If Michael shot it: say so. If submitted: identify submitter/permission. If public/partner source: preserve the source and permitted use. This prevents excellent media from being unusable.
- 8. Your personal Top 12** — Tell me which 12 images feel most like DBF. That gives the future assistant/Claude a human editorial signal instead of letting code decide purely from dimensions.
- 9. Optional: current Instagram originals** — If a Reel was built from a beautiful clean clip, the original pre-caption/pre-music media can become website visual inventory too.
- 10. Optional: a “do not use” folder** — If a photo is private, low quality, stale, or off-brand, segregate it rather than forcing future systems to infer that.

The Gold-Standard Upload Packet

- ☐ TOP_12/ — the 12 photos you most want to see on DBF
- ☐ PHOTOS/ — another 10-30 strong usable photos
- ☐ VIDEO/ — up to 5 clean clips
- ☐ NOTES/media_notes.txt — place, subject, rights/source, and any “must use / do not use” notes
- ☐ ZIP the whole folder and upload it to ChatGPT. Do not send passwords, account credentials, or private personal media.

If Time Runs Out

MINIMUM VIABLE WIN: 12 full-resolution photos + locations + “Michael shot these”/rights note + one ZIP. That is enough for a serious next visual deployment sprint.

1:40-2:00 — Final Selection, Upload, and Stop

Choose the Top 12

- ☐ Would I stop scrolling for it?
- ☐ Does it obviously feel like Delaware?
- ☐ Can I name the location/subject confidently?
- ☐ Is it sharp enough to be large on a phone?
- ☐ Does it replace an illustration or improve a strong story?
- ☐ Does it add a different visual texture from the other Top 12?

Write One Tiny Notes File

Create `NOTES/media\_notes.txt` and use this simple format:

All photos in TOP_12 were shot by Michael unless otherwise noted.

lewes_canal_waterfront_01.jpg – Lewes Canal waterfront – good hero / landscape.
 cape-henlopen_tower_01.heic – Fire-control tower, Cape Henlopen – vertical.
 rehoboth_boardwalk_evening_02.jpg – Rehoboth Boardwalk – evening.

Priority: use the Lewes and Cape Henlopen images first.
 Do not use: [anything you want excluded].

ZIP and Preserve

- ☐ ZIP: DBF_MEDIA_TO_UPLOAD_2026-08-26.zip
- ☐ Save the ZIP in the DBF Desktop/project intake folder
- ☐ Upload that ZIP to this chat or a new DBF chat
- ☐ Also upload the save-point file included in this package if the chat context has changed
- ☐ Stop. Do not spend hour three perfecting filenames.

What Happens After You Upload It

1. I inventory and visually inspect the packet, using your location/rights notes as the source of truth.
2. I map the Top 12 and supporting photos to the highest-value visible surfaces: homepage lead/supporting cards, town rail, deep reads, and article inline breaks.
3. I identify what is truly missing only after reconciling the existing media.
4. I produce the next Claude Code prompt with exact media deployment instructions, not vague “use more photos.”
5. Claude creates optimized derivatives, preserves originals, deploys the visible front-end upgrades, and verifies mobile/desktop production.
6. We compare the live site before/after and use GA4 behavior to judge whether the visual changes improve discovery and retention.

DBF Save Point — August 25, 2026, 1:45 AM ET

This same save point is included as a standalone Markdown file in the ZIP package. Upload that file in a new chat if necessary.

Current phase	Audience acquisition + retention + monetization; visible front-end gains are required from nearly every substantive code sprint.
Latest production commit	`e640ac8` — mobile homepage density/swipe rails + article share UX.
Previous key commits	`98b17c2` — Delaware Coast Live embeds/analytics; `abeb75a` — DBF Weekend restored and event editorial filtering.
Homepage	25,284px / 30 mobile screens before latest sprint → 15,823px / 18.7 screens after; 5 horizontal rails; desktop grids preserved.
Homepage rails	Explore by Town, Stories, Guides, The Edit, Shop.
Live	Real live-feed embeds attach and render with lazy behavior; `live_feed_view` analytics preserved.
Sharing	Articles now have a native Web Share path with fallbacks; `content_share` event added.
QA baseline	26/26 tests; 2,380 links; 0 dead; GA4, sitemap, favicon, social previews, Weekend/Live intact.
Outstanding visual gap	Claude reports 10 of 34 homepage images remain illustrations; real-photo inventory/reconciliation is now the highest-value visible next step.
Deferred	Recently Viewed and persistent mobile bottom navigation. Bottom nav intentionally not added yet.
App direction	Mobile website is the prototype; serious iOS + Android app evaluation waits for real usage data in September.
Next human action	Wednesday Aug. 26: 2-hour media intake block; create/upload `DBF_MEDIA_TO_UPLOAD_2026-08-26.zip`.
Next code sprint after media	Real media reconciliation + deployment to homepage/towns/stories, with measurable acquisition/retention impact. Do not default to infrastructure work.

Wednesday Desk Checklist — Tear-Off Version

- ☐ Start timer for 2:00:00
- ☐ Create DBF_MEDIA_TO_UPLOAD_2026-08-26 folder
- ☐ Open photo sources; COPY only
- ☐ Pull best Lewes / Rehoboth / Cape Henlopen first
- ☐ Add Dewey/Inlet/Delaware Seashore + Bethany/Fenwick
- ☐ Add 1 Homes & Design set if available
- ☐ Add up to 5 clean video clips
- ☐ Take 10-minute break around 1:05
- ☐ Minimal labels: place + subject + rights note
- ☐ Pick Top 12
- ☐ Write media_notes.txt
- ☐ ZIP the folder
- ☐ Save to Desktop DBF intake
- ☐ Upload ZIP + SAVEPOINT.md to ChatGPT
- ☐ STOP at two hours

**THE GOAL IS NOT A PERFECT LIBRARY. THE GOAL IS ENOUGH REAL DELAWARE TO
MAKE THE NEXT PRODUCTION SPRINT VISIBLY BETTER.**